

# L'Dor Vador

HERITAGE TRAVEL



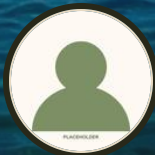
## Curaçao Jewish Heritage Journey

March 3-8, 2027 · 6 days / 5 nights

TEMPLE BETH ELOHIM



Hannah Berkeley  
Cohen  
L'DOR VADOR  
TRAVEL



Rabbi Joel Sisenwine  
GUIDE



Susan Alvares  
Correa  
GUIDE, TBE  
MEMBER, AND  
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IN PARTNERSHIP WITH



Jewish Caribbean Culture  
PRESERVATION FOUNDATION

## OVERVIEW

### The Journey

Join Rabbi Joel Sisenwine and TBE congregant and Curaçao native Susan Alvares Correa as we embark on a remarkable journey to Curaçao, a Caribbean island with an extraordinary Jewish heritage, vibrant culture, and breathtaking beauty.

Together, we'll meet members of today's Jewish community, explore the people and places that shaped this enduring legacy, share Shabbat and Havdalah, and taste the flavors and traditions that have been passed down through generations. We'll also venture into Bandabou, rural Curaçao, to encounter Curaçao's Afro-Curaçaoan history, art, and music, placing the island's Jewish story within the broader cultural and historical landscape in which it developed.

From the historic Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue (home to the oldest continuously active Jewish congregation in the Americas), to centuries-old Jewish cemeteries, historic family homes, and the colorful streets of Willemstad, we'll trace more than 375 years of Jewish life and reflect on a unique Jewish legacy that continues to thrive.

## HIGHLIGHTS

- Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue — the Snoa
- Beth Haim Blenheim Cemetery
- Jewish legacy tour: art, architecture & culture
- Kabbalat Shabbat at the Snoa
- Afro-Curaçaoan history, identity & art in Bandabou
- Open-air Havdalah service with sea view

## AT A GLANCE

### DATES

March 3-8, 2027

### DURATION

6 days / 5 nights

### START / FINISH

Willemstad → Willemstad  
(individual arrivals and departures)

### PACE

Guided touring most days 9:00 AM-3:00 PM, with leisure afternoons

### ACCOMMODATION

Renaissance Wind Creek  
Curaçao Resort, Willemstad

### ITINERARY AT A GLANCE

**Day 1** — Arrival in the  
Crossroads of the Caribbean

**Day 2** — The Sephardic Story  
of Curaçao

**Day 3** — Jewish Legacies in  
Art, Architecture & Culture

**Day 4** — Curaçaoan Jewry  
Through the Ages and on the  
Pages

**Day 5** — Curaçaoan Identity,  
History, and Art

**Day 6** — Farewell to Curaçao

DAY 1 · WEDNESDAY, MARCH 3, 2027

## Arrival in the Crossroads of the Caribbean

*Arrival Day | Welcome Dinner at 6:15 PM*



### Individual Arrivals in Curaçao

- Participants arrive individually and make their way to the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort in Willemstad for check-in.
- Our journey officially begins at the hotel, allowing participants the flexibility to select the flights and travel arrangements that work best for them. Participants are therefore welcome to arrive in Curaçao earlier, extend their stay after the program, or continue onward to another destination.
- For those who would like assistance, Hannah Berkeley Cohen of L'Dor Vador Travel, who will also be accompanying us throughout the journey, will be available to assist participants individually with flight arrangements and airport transfers.
- After check-in, take some time to settle in, relax at the resort, and enjoy your first views of the Caribbean.

### Welcome Dinner & Orientation

- This evening, we come together for the first time at Gouverneur Restaurant for our welcome dinner and orientation.
- Meet your fellow travelers and hosts as we introduce the journey ahead and set the stage for our exploration of Curaçao's remarkable Jewish, Caribbean, and multicultural heritage.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (D)

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DAY 2 · THURSDAY, MARCH 4, 2027

## The Sephardic Story of Curaçao

*Touring: 9:00 AM-3:00 PM*



### Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

### Historic Willemstad

- We begin with a drive through Willemstad, a UNESCO World Heritage city renowned for its distinctive and colorful colonial architecture.

### Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue — The Snoa

- Continue to Mikvé Israel-Emanuel Synagogue, affectionately known as the Snoa.
- Completed in 1732, it is the oldest continuously operating synagogue in the Americas and connects us to a Sephardic Jewish story whose Spanish and Portuguese roots can be traced to the Iberian Peninsula of the 1400s.
- Here, we meet Rabbi Martin Hirsch and enjoy a presentation by Ron Gomes Casseres, a Jewish historian in Curaçao.

### Jewish Museum Curaçao

- Explore the newly expanded and renovated Jewish Museum at your own pace with an audio tour, or choose to join a highlights tour with museum curator, Phyllis Meit.

### Lunch at La Vie en Rose

- Delight in a high-tea-style lunch at La Vie en Rose, in the historic district of Scharloo, known for its elegant colonial mansions, many of which were once owned by prosperous Jewish merchants during the 19th century.

### Curaçao's Historic Jewish Cemeteries

- On our way back to the hotel, we will pass the newer Jewish cemetery established in 1864, as well as historic Beth Haim Blenheim Cemetery.
- Established in 1659 by Curaçao's first 12 Jewish families, Beth Haim Blenheim is the oldest Jewish cemetery in the Caribbean. Its richly carved tombstones preserve the story of Curaçao's early Sephardic community and its far-reaching Atlantic connections.

### Evening in Kura Hulanda

- Step into a walkable village within the city, Kura Hulanda - a beautifully restored area of the inner city that boasts dimly lit restaurants, live music, inviting public plazas, galleries, as well as our restaurant for the evening, Caleo.

### Punda Vibes

- On Thursday nights, Punda's streets fill with local vendors, live music, open bars, and fireworks! Fireworks take place at 8:15pm, and are visible from many places in Punda or Otrobanda, including just outside our restaurant.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

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DAY 3 · FRIDAY, MARCH 5, 2027

## Jewish Legacies in Art, Architecture & Culture

*Touring: 9:00 AM-3:00 PM | Evening Program: 5:00-8:00 PM*



### Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

### Mongui Maduro Historic House

- Visit this meticulously preserved historic plantation house and discover the legacy of the Levy Maduro family, a prominent Sephardic Jewish lineage that significantly influenced Curaçao's economic and social landscape over four generations.

### Landhuis Bloemhof & Cathedral of Thorns

- Continue to Landhuis Bloemhof, which today houses a cultural center dedicated to art, heritage, and nature.
- Learn about the history and ideals of the family that has continued to innovate at Bloemhof across generations.
- Visit the extraordinary Cathedral of Thorns, conceived as a space for reflection and healing and as a powerful metaphor for Curaçao's complex history, including colonialism and slavery.

### Lunch at Number Ten

- Enjoy lunch together at Number Ten.

### Chobolobo Distillery

- Discover the history and production of Curaçao's iconic Blue Curaçao liqueur, invented by a local Sephardic Jewish family.

### Kabbalat Shabbat

- As the sun begins to set, we come together for Kabbalat Shabbat at the Snoa.

### Shabbat Dinner

- Following services, return to the resort for an outdoor Shabbat dinner, celebrating the arrival of Shabbat together in Curaçao.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

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DAY 4 · SATURDAY, MARCH 6, 2027

## Curaçaoan Jewry Through the Ages and on the Pages

*Day Program: 9:00 AM-4:00 PM | Evening Program from 6:30 PM*



### Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

### Shabbat Morning Services at the Snoa

- This is a very unique service featuring prayers in Papiamentu, Portuguese, Dutch, Hebrew, English and Spanish. The main service is in English and Hebrew and we will pray in the sanctuary that is nearly 300 years old.

### Time for reflection and exploration

- After Shabbat morning services the afternoon is intentionally left free of scheduled programming, allowing everyone to experience the island at their own pace.
- Return to the hotel's infinity pool, or take a self-guided exploratory walk through Willemstad's historic center.
- Those who would like to explore more may choose from a variety of optional excursions and activities. Suggestions will be offered by your hosts.

## Art, Books & Dinner in Historic Otrobanda

- Arrive on your own, or walk over with the group to Sebastopol 9, an art gallery housed in a monumental 18th-century residence that has remained in the same family for roughly three centuries. Today, Philip Chapman and his brothers have given the property a new cultural life as a gallery showcasing emerging Curaçaoan artists.
- Enjoy a private catered dinner buffet inside the gallery, surrounded by contemporary local art.
- During the evening, meet Anneroos Reich, an active member of Curaçao's Jewish community and a board member of the Jewish Museum. Especially for our group, she will open her bookstore Hirsch & Reich outside of opening hours, presenting a curated selection of books relevant to our journey, including Judaica, regional history, literature, art, and culture.
- This encounter also offers an informal opportunity to speak with Anneroos about contemporary Jewish life in Curaçao and everyday island life, connecting the historical Jewish story explored throughout our journey with the community that lives it today.

## After Dinner — Evening at Leisure

- Stroll back to the hotel at your own pace, or continue exploring the historic Otrobanda neighborhood by night. Your hotel is an easy 5-minute stroll away.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, D)

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DAY 5 · SUNDAY, MARCH 7, 2027

## Curaçaoan Identity, History, and Art

*Bandabou | Afro-Curaçaoan Heritage, Art & Identity*



## Breakfast

- Enjoy the breakfast buffet at our resort.

## Depart for Bandabou

- Travel west into Bandabou, Curaçao's rural western region, where plantation history, Afro-Curaçaoan traditions, and the island's struggle for freedom remain deeply embedded in the landscape.



## Tula Museum at Landhuis Kenepa

- Visit the Tula Museum, housed at the former Kenepa plantation, one of the principal sites associated with Curaçao's great slave revolt of 1795.
- We are personally welcomed by Jeanne Henriquez, historian, activist, and director of the museum.
- Through the story of Tula, leader of the 1795 uprising and today recognized as a national hero of Curaçao, Jeanne introduces us to the history of slavery, resistance, emancipation, and the continuing process of confronting Curaçao's colonial past.
- Our conversation moves beyond history to explore nation-building, national identity, collective memory, and the importance of national heroes.

## Santa Cruz

- Continue to Santa Cruz, a secluded beach nestled within one of Bandabou's beautiful natural coves.
- We are joined by Pernell Saturnino, Grammy Award-winning percussionist and Berklee College of Music alumnus, for an encounter with Curaçao's musical heritage.
- Pernell introduces us to traditional Afro-Curaçaoan rhythms and instruments, including the chapi and tambú, and explores how rhythm, music, resistance, spirituality, and community are intertwined in Curaçaoan culture.
- Enjoy a breezy, open-air buffet-style lunch at the legendary home base of Juni "Captain Goodlife" Obersi, one of the island's colorful local personalities. Refresh with a cocktail on the shaded terrace overlooking the bay, or enjoy a leisurely stroll along the beach. This lunch interlude offers an opportunity to experience another side of life in rural Curaçao before continuing our journey.

## Art, Rhythm & Curaçaoan Identity: Yubi Kirindongo & Pernell Saturnino

- Continue to the home and atelier of internationally renowned Curaçaoan artist Yubi Kirindongo.
- Known especially for transforming discarded materials into powerful works of art, Kirindongo has developed a distinctive visual language rooted in Curaçao, the African diaspora, social consciousness, and the transformation of what society has cast aside. He personally welcomes us into his world and introduces us to his life, artistic philosophy, and work.
- Drinks/Cocktails will be provided.

## Farewell Dinner

- On our final night in Curaçao, we unite for a festive open-air farewell dinner at our resort.
- Over dinner, we reflect on the people we have met, the stories we have encountered, and all that we have experienced together during our Caribbean journey.

Overnight: Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad · (B, L, D)

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DAY 6 · MONDAY, MARCH 8, 2027

## Farewell to Curaçao

*Departure Day*

### Breakfast

- Enjoy a final breakfast at our resort.

### Individual Departures

- Our shared journey concludes at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort.
- Participants depart according to their individual travel arrangements. Those extending their stay in Curaçao or continuing onward to another destination are free to do so according to their own schedules.

End of Program · (B)

## YOUR HOSTS



### Hannah Berkeley Cohen CO-FOUNDER

Hannah Berkeley Cohen is an Ohio native who has called the Caribbean home since 2012. After

spending a semester abroad at the University of Havana, she moved to Cuba to document the country's youth culture, the everyday life of the Cuban middle class, and the island's dwindling Jewish community. By 2015, she had become the New York Times' primary stringer based in Havana, reporting on American foreign policy toward Cuba, the death of Fidel Castro, and the historic visits of President Obama and the Pope. In Havana, she met with dozens of groups organized by the JDC (American Jewish Joint Distribution Committee), synagogues across North America, and Jewish individuals returning for the first time to Cuba since their parents or grandparents left half a century earlier.

Reporting for major media outlets gave Hannah rare access to Cuba's layered society; in 2015, the ease in regulations for travel for Americans to Cuba allowed Hannah to share her insight of the island, with the goal of showcasing a nuanced Cuba: beyond rum, cigars, colorful buildings, and classic cars.

She founded Cuba Rising, a bespoke travel company for Americans seeking to uncover the complex realities of modern Cuba. From meetings with ambassadors to conversations with black-market money exchangers, and culinary workshops with Michelin-starred chefs to cozy cooking lessons with grandmothers in modest home kitchens, Cuba Rising offered intimate cultural exchanges with people from all ranks of Cuban society. Each trip was highly customized, with group sizes capped at eight to ensure flexibility and depth of experience. Hannah is fluent in English and Spanish.

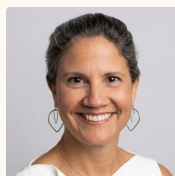
Using her experience in Cuba, Hannah moved to Curaçao in 2024 to delve deeper into the Jewish history and heritage of the island, and create culturally-relevant programs for North American travelers.



### Rabbi Joel Sisenwine SPIRITUAL LEADER AND GUIDE

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### Susan Alvares Correa GUIDE, TBE MEMBER, AND JCCPF REPRESENTATIVE

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## WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Five nights at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort, Willemstad
- Breakfast daily at the resort
- Meals where indicated in the itinerary (welcome dinner, Day 2 lunch, Day 3 lunch and Shabbat dinner, Day 4 gallery dinner, farewell dinner)
- All guided touring, entrances, private encounters and transportation as described
- Gratuities

*Pricing and booking details will be shared once the program is finalized. Registering your interest is not a booking.*

## PROGRAM NOTES

**Flights:** International airfare is not included in the group arrangements. Participants book their own flights, providing maximum flexibility to arrive early, extend their stay, or continue onward after Curaçao.

**Travel Assistance:** Participants who would like assistance with flights or airport transfers may contact Hannah Berkeley Cohen of L'Dor Vador Travel, who will also serve as a host throughout the journey.

**Hotel:** The group program is based at the Renaissance Wind Creek Curaçao Resort in Willemstad.

## NOT INCLUDED

- International airfare (participants book their own flights)
- Airport transfers (assistance available on request)
- Meals not indicated in the itinerary
- Optional excursions on the free day
- Travel insurance recommended and available for purchase through L'Dor Vador Travel

**Meals:** Breakfast is included daily at the resort. Other meals are included where specifically indicated in the itinerary.

**Program Flexibility:** The itinerary reflects the planned program. Specific speakers, hosts, cultural figures, and private encounters are subject to availability. Should any featured individual be unavailable during the group's visit, L'Dor Vador Travel will arrange a suitable and equally compelling alternative whenever possible.

**Optional Programming:** Additional programming with Rabbi Joel and/or Susan may be offered during periods designated as leisure time and will be communicated to participants on the island.

## About L'Dor Vador Travel

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## QUESTIONS OR TO REGISTER YOUR INTEREST

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